为贫穷影像辩护

In Defense of the Poor Image

Hito Steyerl

英文原段 / 中文译文 • 含原文配图及注释

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编译说明：依据读者提供的正文和六张配图制作，按所提供文本的段落逐段对照；补回原网页注释编号，移除广告及导航文字。中文为本次阅读译文。“poor image”统一译作“贫穷影像”，“visual bond”译作“视觉纽带”。文献标题中文为本译本译名；致谢和作者简介沿用2009年原文。

The poor image is a copy in motion. Its quality is bad, its resolution substandard. As it accelerates, it deteriorates. It is a ghost of an image, a preview, a thumbnail, an errant idea, an itinerant image distributed for free, squeezed through slow digital connections, compressed, reproduced, ripped, remixed, as well as copied and pasted into other channels of distribution.

贫穷影像是一份流动中的拷贝。它画质糟糕，分辨率不达标。流动得越快，它就损耗得越厉害。它是影像的幽灵，是预览图、缩略图、游移的念头；它是免费传播、四处漂泊的影像，挤过缓慢的数字连接，被压缩、复制、抓取、混剪，也被复制粘贴到其他传播渠道中。

The poor image is a rag or a rip; an AVI or a JPEG, a lumpen proletarian in the class society of appearances, ranked and valued according to its resolution. The poor image has been uploaded, downloaded, shared, reformatted, and reedited. It transforms quality into accessibility, exhibition value into cult value, films into clips, contemplation into distraction. The image is liberated from the vaults of cinemas and archives and thrust into digital uncertainty, at the expense of its own substance. The poor image tends towards abstraction: it is a visual idea in its very becoming.

贫穷影像是一块破布，或一份抓取的文件；一个 AVI，或一个 JPEG，是表象的阶级社会中的流氓无产者，按分辨率被排序和估价。贫穷影像被上传、下载、分享、转换格式、重新剪辑。它以画质换取可获取性，把展示价值转化为膜拜价值，把电影变成片段，把凝神观看变成分心消遣。影像从影院和档案馆的库房中获得解放，却以损失自身的实质为代价，被抛入数字世界的不确定性之中。贫穷影像趋向抽象：它是一个正在生成的视觉观念。

The poor image is an illicit fifth-generation bastard of an original image. Its genealogy is dubious. Its filenames are deliberately misspelled. It often defies patrimony, national culture, or indeed copyright. It is passed on as a lure, a decoy, an index, or as a reminder of its former visual self. It mocks the promises of digital technology. Not only is it often degraded to the point of being just a hurried blur, one even doubts whether it could be called an image at all. Only digital technology could produce such a dilapidated image in the first place.

贫穷影像是原始影像的第五代非法私生子。它的谱系可疑，文件名被故意拼错。它常常违抗文化遗产、民族文化，甚至版权的规约。它作为诱饵、幌子、索引，或作为对昔日自身影像形态的提醒而被传递。它嘲弄数字技术的许诺。它不仅经常退化为一团匆忙掠过的模糊痕迹，甚至让人怀疑，它是否还算得上影像。首先，也只有数字技术才能制造出这样破败的影像。

Poor images are the contemporary Wretched of the Screen, the debris of audiovisual production, the trash that washes up on the digital economies' shores. They testify to the violent dislocation, transferrals, and displacement of images—their acceleration and circulation within the vicious cycles of audiovisual capitalism. Poor images are dragged around the globe as commodities or their effigies, as gifts or as bounty. They spread pleasure or death threats, conspiracy theories or bootlegs, resistance or stultification. Poor images show the rare, the obvious, and the unbelievable—that is, if we can still manage to decipher it.

贫穷影像是当代的“屏幕上的受苦者”，是视听生产的残骸，是被冲上数字经济海岸的垃圾。它们见证影像遭受的暴力错置、转移和迁移，见证影像在视听资本主义恶性循环中的加速与流通。贫穷影像被当作商品或商品的替身、礼物或战利品，拖拽着穿行全球。它们传播快感或死亡威胁、阴谋论或盗版、反抗或愚化。贫穷影像展示罕见之物、显而易见之物和难以置信之物——当然，前提是我们仍能辨认它们。



Shoveling pirated DVDs in Taiyuan, Shanxi province, China, April 20, 2008. From here.
2008年4月20日，中国山西太原，用铲子清理盗版DVD。图片来源见原文链接。

1. Low Resolutions
1. 低分辨率

In one of Woody Allen's films the main character is out of focus.[1] It's not a technical problem but some sort of disease that has befallen him: his image is consistently blurred. Since Allen's character is an actor, this becomes a major problem: he is unable to find work. His lack of definition turns into a material problem. Focus is identified as a class position, a position of ease and privilege, while being out of focus lowers one's value as an image.

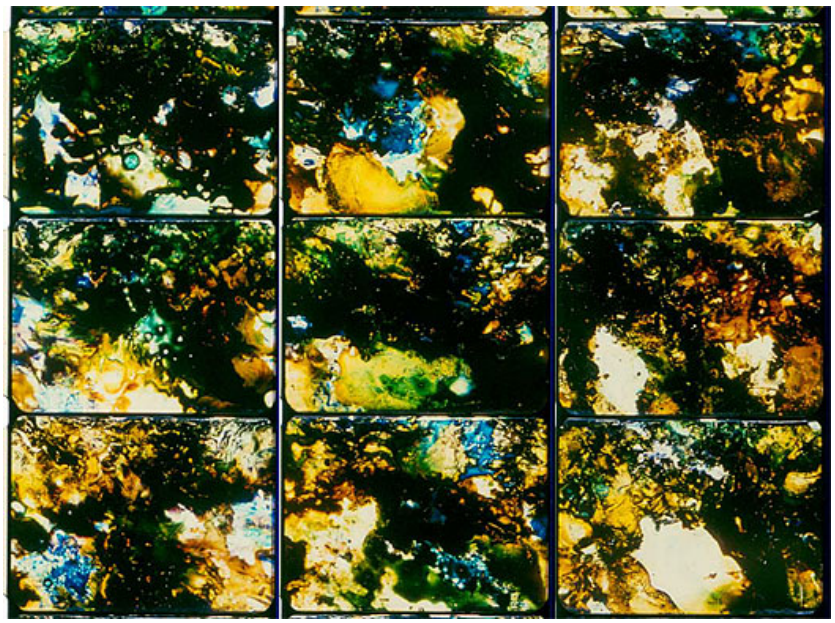
伍迪·艾伦的一部电影里，主人公失焦了。[1] 这不是技术问题，而像是他患上了某种疾病：他的影像始终模糊不清。由于艾伦饰演的角色是演员，这成了大麻烦：他找不到工作。他的不清晰变成了一个物质层面的问题。清晰对焦意味着一种阶级位置，一种安逸而享有特权的位置；失焦则降低了他作为影像的价值。

The contemporary hierarchy of images, however, is not only based on sharpness, but also and primarily on resolution. Just look at any electronics store and this system, described by Harun Farocki in a notable 2007 interview, becomes immediately apparent.[2]In the class society of images, cinema takes on the role of a flagship store. In flagship stores high-end products are marketed in an upscale environment. More affordable derivatives of the same images circulate as DVDs, on broadcast television or online, as poor images.

然而，当代的影像等级不仅建立在清晰度之上，更主要建立在分辨率之上。只要看看任何一家电器商店，哈伦・法罗基在2007年一次值得注意的访谈中描述的这套体系，就会立刻显现出来。[2] 在影像的阶级社会中，电影扮演旗舰店的角色。在旗舰店里，高端商品在高档环境中出售。同样影像更便宜的衍生版本，则以 DVD、电视播出或在线内容的形式，作为贫穷影像流通。

Obviously, a high-resolution image looks more brilliant and impressive, more mimetic and magic, more scary and seductive than a poor one. It is more rich, so to speak. Now, even consumer formats are increasingly adapting to the tastes of cineastes and esthetes, who insisted on 35 mm film as a guarantee of pristine visuality. The insistence upon analog film as the sole medium of visual importance resounded throughout discourses on cinema, almost regardless of their ideological inflection. It never mattered that these high-end economies of film production were (and still are) firmly anchored in systems of national culture, capitalist studio production, the cult of mostly male genius, and the original version, and thus are often conservative in their very structure. Resolution was fetishized as if its lack amounted to castration of the author. The cult of film gauge dominated even independent film production. The rich image established its own set of hierarchies, with new technologies offering more and more possibilities to creatively degrade it.

显然，与贫穷影像相比，高分辨率影像看起来更明亮夺目，更具拟真性与魔力，也更惊人、更诱人。可以说，它更富裕。如今，连消费级格式都越来越迎合迷影者和唯美主义者的口味；他们坚持认为，35毫米胶片能够保证纯净无瑕的视觉品质。把模拟胶片认作唯一具有视觉重要性的媒介，这种主张几乎不分意识形态立场地回响于电影论述中。至于这些高端电影生产经济，曾经而且至今仍牢牢扎根于民族文化体系、资本主义制片厂生产、以男性为主的天才崇拜及原版崇拜，并因此在结构上往往相当保守，这一点却从未被当回事。分辨率被奉为拜物对象，仿佛缺少它就等于阉割了作者。甚至独立电影生产也受胶片规格崇拜支配。富裕影像建立起自己的种种等级，而新技术则为以创造性方式使其降质，提供了越来越多的可能。



Nine 35mm film frames from Stan Brakhage's Existence is Song, 1987.
斯坦・布拉哈格《存在即歌》（Existence is Song，1987）的九格35毫米胶片画格。

2. Resurrection (as Poor Images)
2. 复活（作为贫穷影像）

But insisting on rich images also had more serious consequences. A speaker at a recent conference on the film essay refused to show clips from a piece by Humphrey Jennings because no proper film projection was available. Although there was at the speaker's disposal a perfectly standard DVD player and video projector, the audience was left to imagine what those images might have looked like.

但坚持富裕影像，也产生了更严重的后果。在最近一次关于散文电影的会议上，一位发言者因为现场没有合适的胶片放映设备，拒绝播放汉弗莱・詹宁斯某部作品的片段。尽管现场有一台完全合乎标准的 DVD 播放机和视频投影机，观众仍只能自行想象那些影像可能是什么样子。

In this case the invisibility of the image was more or less voluntary and based on aesthetic premises. But it has a much more general equivalent based on the consequences of neoliberal policies. Twenty or even thirty years ago, the neoliberal restructuring of media production began slowly obscuring non-commercial imagery, to the point where experimental and essayistic cinema became almost invisible. As it became prohibitively expensive to keep these works circulating in cinemas, so were they also deemed too marginal to be broadcast on television. Thus they slowly disappeared not just from cinemas, but from the public sphere as well. Video essays and experimental films remained for the most part unseen save for some rare screenings in metropolitan film museums or film clubs, projected in their original resolution before disappearing again into the darkness of the archive.

在这个例子里，影像的不可见多少出于自愿，并建立在某种美学前提上。但在更普遍的层面，新自由主义政策的后果造成了类似情形。二三十年前，媒介生产的新自由主义重组，开始慢慢遮蔽非商业影像，以至于实验电影和散文电影几乎无从得见。让这些作品持续在影院流通的成本高到难以承担，而电视又认为它们过于边缘，不值得播出。于是，它们逐渐消失的不仅是影院，也是公共领域。除了在大都市的电影博物馆或电影俱乐部中偶尔以原始分辨率放映之外，视频论文和实验电影大多无人得见，随后又重新消失在档案库的黑暗中。

This development was of course connected to the neoliberal radicalization of the concept of culture as commodity, to the commercialization of cinema, its dispersion into multiplexes, and the marginalization of independent filmmaking. It was also connected to the restructuring of global media industries and the establishment of monopolies over the audiovisual in certain countries or territories. In this way, resistant or non-conformist visual matter disappeared from the surface into an underground of alternative archives and collections, kept alive only by a network of committed organizations and individuals, who would circulate bootlegged VHS copies amongst themselves. Sources for these were extremely rare—tapes moved from hand to hand, depending on word of mouth, within circles of friends and colleagues. With the possibility to stream video online, this condition started to dramatically change. An increasing number of rare materials reappeared on publicly accessible platforms, some of them carefully curated (Ubuweb) and some just a pile of stuff (YouTube).

这一发展当然与新自由主义把文化视为商品这一观念的激进化、电影的商业化及其向多厅影院的分散，以及独立电影制作的边缘化有关。它也与全球媒介产业的重组，以及某些国家或地区对视听领域垄断的确立有关。就这样，具有抵抗性或不从众的视觉材料从地表消失，转入另类档案与收藏的地下世界；只有一些投入其中的组织与个人组成的网络，在彼此传递盗版 VHS 拷贝的过程中，维系着它们的生命。这些材料的来源极为稀少——录像带依靠口耳相传，在朋友和同事的小圈子里辗转。随着在线视频流播成为可能，这种状况开始发生剧变。越来越多的珍稀材料重新出现在公众可以访问的平台上，其中一些经过精心策划，例如 Ubuweb；另一些则只是材料的堆积，例如 YouTube。

At present, there are at least twenty torrents of Chris Marker's film essays available online. If you want a retrospective, you can have it. But the economy of poor images is about more than just downloads: you can keep the files, watch them again, even reedit or improve them if you think it necessary. And the results circulate. Blurred AVI files of half-forgotten masterpieces are exchanged on semi-secret P2P platforms. Clandestine cell-phone videos smuggled out of museums are broadcast on YouTube. DVDs of artists' viewing copies are bartered.[3] Many works of avant-garde, essayistic, and non-commercial cinema have been resurrected as poor images. Whether they like it or not.

此刻，网上至少能找到二十个克里斯·马克散文电影的种子。想办回顾展，你就可以办。但贫穷影像的经济远不止下载：你可以保存文件、反复观看，甚至在认为有必要时重新剪辑或改善它们，而结果又会继续流通。半被遗忘的杰作，以模糊的 AVI 文件形式在半秘密的 P2P 平台上交换。从博物馆中偷偷带出的手机录像，在 YouTube 上播出。艺术家作品的审片 DVD 被拿来交换。[3] 许多先锋电影、散文电影和非商业电影，都作为贫穷影像复活了，不管它们愿不愿意。



Illustration in the original article (no caption).
原网页配图，无图注。

3. Privatization and Piracy
3. 私有化与盗版

That rare prints of militant, experimental, and classical works of cinema as well as video art reappear as poor images is significant on another level. Their situation reveals much more than the content or appearance of the images themselves: it also reveals the conditions of their marginalization, the constellation of social forces leading to their online circulation as poor images.[4] Poor images are poor because they are not assigned any value within the class society of images—their status as illicit or degraded grants them exemption from its criteria. Their lack of resolution attests to their appropriation and displacement.[5]

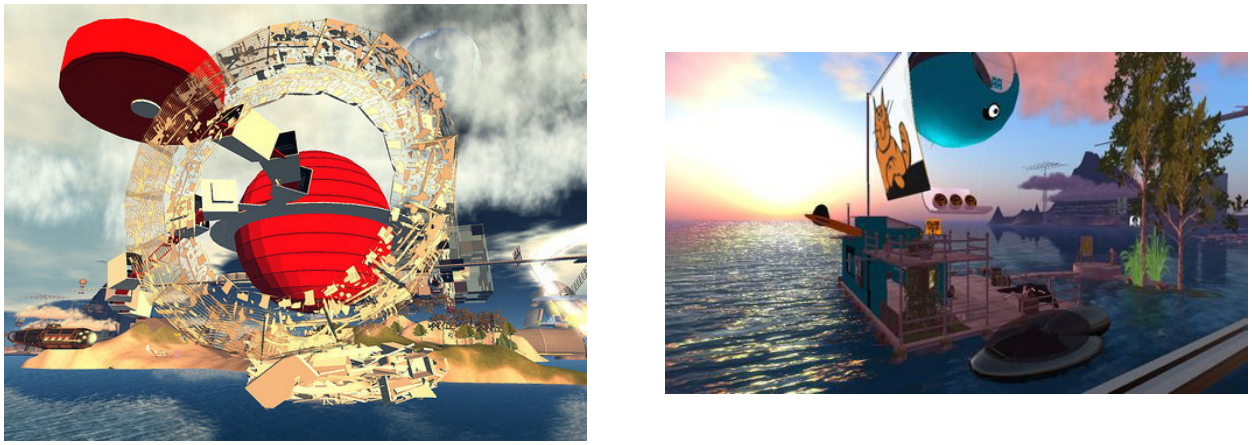
战斗性电影、实验电影、经典电影和录像艺术的珍稀拷贝，作为贫穷影像重新出现，这在另一个层面同样意义重大。它们的处境揭示的远不止影像本身的内容或外观，还揭示了它们被边缘化的条件，以及使它们作为贫穷影像在网上流通的社会力量格局。[4] 贫穷影像之所以贫穷，是因为在影像的阶级社会中，它们没有被赋予任何价值；它们非法或降质的地位，使它们免受这套评价标准的约束。它们分辨率的不足，见证了自身被挪用和迁移的过程。[5]

Obviously, this condition is not only connected to the neoliberal restructuring of media production and digital technology; it also has to do with the post-socialist and postcolonial restructuring of nation states, their cultures, and their archives. While some nation states are dismantled or fall apart, new cultures and traditions are invented and new histories created. This obviously also affects film archives—in many cases, a whole heritage of film prints is left without its supporting framework of national culture. As I once observed in the case of a film museum in Sarajevo, the national archive can find its next life in the form of a video-rental store.[6] Pirate copies seep out of such archives through disorganized privatization. On the other hand, even the British Library sells off its contents online at astronomical prices.

显然，这种状况不仅与媒介生产的新自由主义重组和数字技术有关，也与民族国家及其文化和档案的后社会主义、后殖民重组有关。一些民族国家被拆解或分崩离析之际，新的文化与传统被发明，新的历史被创造。这显然也影响了电影档案——在许多情况下，整批胶片遗产失去了民族文化这一支撑框架。正如我曾在萨拉热窝的一家电影博物馆观察到的那样，国家档案可能以录像带出租店的形式获得来生。[6] 在无序的私有化过程中，盗版拷贝从这些档案中渗流出来。另一方面，就连大英图书馆也以天价在网上出售馆藏内容。

As Kodwo Eshun has noted, poor images circulate partly in the void left by state-cinema organizations who find it too difficult to operate as a 16/35-mm archive or to maintain any kind of distribution infrastructure in the contemporary era.[7] From this perspective, the poor image reveals the decline and degradation of the film essay, or indeed any experimental and non-commercial cinema, which in many places was made possible because the production of culture was considered a task of the state. Privatization of media production gradually grew more important than state controlled/sponsored media production. But, on the other hand, the rampant privatization of intellectual content, along with online marketing and commodification, also enable piracy and appropriation; it gives rise to the circulation of poor images.

正如科德沃・埃顺所指出的，贫穷影像的流通，部分发生在国家电影机构留下的空缺中：这些机构发现，当代条件下，要作为16或35毫米胶片档案馆运作，或维持任何形式的发行基础设施，都过于困难。[7] 从这个角度看，贫穷影像揭示了散文电影，乃至任何实验与非商业电影的衰落和降质；在许多地方，这些电影曾经之所以可能，是因为文化生产被视为国家的职责。媒介生产的私有化逐渐取得了高于国家控制或资助的媒介生产的重要性。但另一方面，知识内容肆无忌惮的私有化，加上网络营销和商品化，也使盗版与挪用成为可能；它催生了贫穷影像的流通。



Chris Marker's virtual home on Second Life, May 29, 2009.
克里斯・马克在《第二人生》中的虚拟家园，2009年5月29日。

4. Imperfect Cinema

4. 不完美的电影

The emergence of poor images reminds one of a classic Third Cinema manifesto, For an Imperfect Cinema, by Juan García Espinosa, written in Cuba in the late 1960s.[A] Espinosa argues for an imperfect cinema because, in his words, "perfect cinema—technically and artistically masterful—is almost always reactionary cinema." The imperfect cinema is one that strives to overcome the divisions of labor within class society. It merges art with life and science, blurring the distinction between consumer and producer, audience and author. It insists upon its own imperfection, is popular but not consumerist, committed without becoming bureaucratic.

贫穷影像的出现，让人想到第三电影的一篇经典宣言：胡安·加西亚·埃斯皮诺萨在20世纪60年代末于古巴写下的《为一种不完美的电影》。[A] 埃斯皮诺萨主张不完美的电影，因为用他的话说，"完美的电影——在技术和艺术上娴熟精湛的电影——几乎总是反动的电影"。不完美的电影力图克服阶级社会中的劳动分工。它把艺术与生活、科学相融合，模糊消费者与生产者、观众与作者的区分。它坚持自身的不完美，具有大众性却不奉行消费主义，有所担当却不陷入官僚作风。

In his manifesto, Espinosa also reflects on the promises of new media. He clearly predicts that the development of video technology will jeopardize the elitist position of traditional filmmakers and enable some sort of mass film production: an art of the people. Like the economy of poor images, imperfect cinema diminishes the distinctions between author and audience and merges life and art. Most of all, its visuality is resolutely compromised: blurred, amateurish, and full of artifacts.

在宣言中，埃斯皮诺萨也思考了新媒介的许诺。他明确预言，录像技术的发展将动摇传统电影制作者的精英地位，使某种群众性的电影生产成为可能：一种人民的艺术。与贫穷影像的经济一样，不完美的电影减弱了作者与观众的区分，并融合生活与艺术。最重要的是，它的视觉形态明确接受了品质的折损：模糊、业余，充满影像伪影。

In some way, the economy of poor images corresponds to the description of imperfect cinema, while the description of perfect cinema represents rather the concept of cinema as a flagship store. But the real and contemporary imperfect cinema is also much more ambivalent and affective than Espinosa had anticipated. On the one hand, the economy of poor images, with its immediate possibility of worldwide distribution and its ethics of remix and appropriation, enables the participation of a much larger group of producers than ever before. But this does not mean that these opportunities are only used for progressive ends. Hate speech, spam, and other rubbish make their way through digital connections as well. Digital communication has also become one of the most contested markets—a zone that has long been subjected to an ongoing original accumulation and to massive (and, to a certain extent, successful) attempts at privatization.

在某种意义上，贫穷影像的经济对应着对不完美电影的描述，而对完美电影的描述，则更接近把电影视为旗舰店的观念。但当代真正的不完美电影，比埃斯皮诺萨所预想的更充满矛盾，也更具情动性。一方面，贫穷影像的经济凭借即时向全球传播的可能，以及混剪和挪用的伦理，使比以往任何时候都更庞大的生产者群体能够参与其中。但这并不意味着，这些机会只会被用于进步的目的。仇恨言论、垃圾邮件及其他垃圾，同样穿行于数字连接之间。数字通信也已成为竞争最激烈的市场之一——这片区域长期承受着持续的原始积累，以及大规模、并在一定程度上取得成功的私有化企图。

The networks in which poor images circulate thus constitute both a platform for a fragile new common interest and a battleground for commercial and national agendas. They contain experimental and artistic material, but also incredible amounts of porn and paranoia. While the territory of poor images allows access to excluded imagery, it is also permeated by the most advanced commodification techniques. While it enables the users' active participation in the creation and distribution of content, it also drafts them into production. Users become the editors, critics, translators, and (co-)authors of poor images.

因此，贫穷影像流通的网络，既是脆弱的新共同利益的平台，也是商业与国家议程的战场。其中既有实验性和艺术性材料，也有数量惊人的色情与偏执妄想。贫穷影像的领域让人能够接触遭到排斥的影像，却也被最先进的商品化技术所渗透。它使用户得以积极参与内容的创造和传播，同时也把他们征召进生产。用户成为贫穷影像的剪辑者、评论者、翻译者和共同作者。

Poor images are thus popular images—images that can be made and seen by the many. They express all the contradictions of the contemporary crowd: its opportunism, narcissism, desire for autonomy and creation, its inability to focus or make up its mind, its constant readiness for transgression and simultaneous submission.[8] Altogether, poor images present a snapshot of the affective condition of the crowd, its neurosis, paranoia, and fear, as well as its craving for intensity, fun, and distraction. The condition of the images speaks not only of countless transfers and reformattings, but also of the countless people who cared enough about them to convert them over and over again, to add subtitles, reedit, or upload them.

因此，贫穷影像也是大众影像——许多人都能制作和观看的影像。它们表达当代群众的全部矛盾：机会主义、自恋、追求自主与创造的欲望，无法集中注意力或作出决定的状态，随时准备越界却又同时顺从的倾向。[8] 总体而言，贫穷影像呈现了群众情动状态的一幅快照：他们的神经症、偏执和恐惧，以及对强度、乐趣和消遣的渴望。影像的状况所诉说的，不仅是无数次转移和格式转换，也是无数人的存在：他们如此在意这些影像，以至于一遍遍地转换它们，添加字幕，重新剪辑或上传。

In this light, perhaps one has to redefine the value of the image, or, more precisely, to create a new perspective for it. Apart from resolution and exchange value, one might imagine another form of value defined by velocity, intensity, and spread. Poor images are poor because they are heavily compressed and travel quickly. They lose matter and gain speed. But they also express a condition of dematerialization, shared not only with the legacy of conceptual art but above all with contemporary modes of semiotic production.[9] Capital's semiotic turn, as described by Felix Guattari,[10] plays in favor of the creation and dissemination of compressed and flexible data packages that can be integrated into ever-newer combinations and sequences.[11]

如此看来，我们或许必须重新定义影像的价值；更准确地说，为它建立一种新的视角。除分辨率与交换价值之外，我们还可以设想另一种由速度、强度和传播范围界定的价值形式。贫穷影像之所以贫穷，是因为它们受到高度压缩，并且流动迅速。它们失去物质，获得速度。但它们也表达了一种去物质化的状态；这一点既与观念艺术的遗产相通，更与当代符号生产方式相通。[9] 费利克斯・瓜塔里所描述的资本的符号转向，[10] 有利于创造和传播经过压缩、灵活的数据包，使其可以被整合进不断翻新的组合与序列之中。[11]



Thomas Ruff, jpeg rl104, 2007.
托马斯·鲁夫，jpeg rl104，2007年。

This flattening-out of visual content—the concept-in-becoming of the images—positions them within a general informational turn, within economies of knowledge that tear images and their captions out of context into the swirl of permanent capitalist deterritorialization.[12] The history of conceptual art describes this dematerialization of the art object first as a resistant move against the fetish value of visibility. Then, however, the dematerialized art object turns out to be perfectly adapted to the semioticization of capital, and thus to the conceptual turn of capitalism.[13] In a way, the poor image is subject to a similar tension. On the one hand, it operates against the fetish value of high resolution. On the other hand, this is precisely why it also ends up being perfectly integrated into an information capitalism thriving on compressed attention spans, on impression rather than immersion, on intensity rather than contemplation, on previews rather than screenings.

视觉内容的这种扁平化——影像正在生成的概念——把它们置于一种总体的信息转向之中，置于知识经济之中；在其中，影像及其图注被扯离语境，卷入持续的资本主义解域化漩涡。[12] 观念艺术的历史，起初把艺术对象的去物质化描述为对可见性之拜物价值的抵抗。然而，随后却发现，去物质化的艺术对象完全适应资本的符号化，从而也适应资本主义的观念转向。[13] 在某种意义上，贫穷影像承受着类似的张力。一方面，它反对高分辨率的拜物价值。另一方面，恰恰因此，它最终也被完美地整合进信息资本主义：后者依赖被压缩的注意力时长，依赖印象而非沉浸，依赖强度而非凝思，依赖预览而非放映。

5. Comrade, what is your visual bond today?
5. 同志，今天你的视觉纽带是什么？

But, simultaneously, a paradoxical reversal happens. The circulation of poor images creates a circuit, which fulfills the original ambitions of militant and (some) essayistic and experimental cinema—to create an alternative economy of images, an imperfect cinema existing inside as well as beyond and under commercial media streams. In the age of file-sharing, even marginalized content circulates again and reconnects dispersed worldwide audiences.

但与此同时，一种悖论式的逆转也发生了。贫穷影像的流通形成一个回路，实现了战斗性电影，以及某些散文电影和实验电影的最初抱负：创造一种另类影像经济，一种既存在于商业媒介流内部，又存在于其外部与下方的不完美电影。在文件共享时代，即便是被边缘化的内容，也重新流通起来，再度连接起散布世界各地的观众。

The poor image thus constructs anonymous global networks just as it creates a shared history. It builds alliances as it travels, provokes translation or mistranslation, and creates new publics and debates. By losing its visual substance it recovers some of its political punch and creates a new aura around it. This aura is no longer based on the permanence of the "original," but on the transience of the copy. It is no longer anchored within a classical public sphere mediated and supported by the frame of the nation state or corporation, but floats on the surface of temporary and dubious data pools.[14] By drifting away from the vaults of cinema, it is propelled onto new and ephemeral screens stitched together by the desires of dispersed spectators.

贫穷影像由此在创造共同历史的同时，建构起匿名的全球网络。它在传播中建立联盟，引发翻译或误译，创造新的公众和辩论。它通过丧失视觉上的实质，重新获得部分政治冲击力，并在自身周围创造一种新的灵韵。这种灵韵不再建立于"原作"的恒久性，而建立于拷贝的短暂性。它不再锚定于由民族国家或企业框架所中介、支撑的经典公共领域，而漂浮在临时且可疑的数据池表面。[14] 当它从电影的库房漂离，便被推向新的、转瞬即逝的屏幕；这些屏幕由分散观众的欲望缝合在一起。

The circulation of poor images thus creates "visual bonds," as Dziga Vertov once called them.[15] This "visual bond" was, according to Vertov, supposed to link the workers of the world with each other.[16] He imagined a sort of communist, visual, Adamic language that could not only inform or entertain, but also organize its viewers. In a sense, his dream has come true, if mostly under the rule of a global information capitalism whose audiences are linked almost in a physical sense by mutual excitement, affective attunement, and anxiety.

因此，贫穷影像的流通创造了吉加•维尔托夫曾说的"视觉纽带"。[15] 按照维尔托夫的设想，这种"视觉纽带"应把全世界的工人彼此连接起来。[16] 他想象一种共产主义的、视觉的、亚当式的语言，它不仅能够传递信息或提供娱乐，还能组织观众。在某种意义上，他的梦想已经成真，尽管这主要是在全球信息资本主义的统治之下：观众通过共同的激动、情动的同调与焦虑，以几乎是身体性的方式彼此相连。

But there is also the circulation and production of poor images based on cell phone cameras, home computers, and unconventional forms of distribution. Its optical connections—collective editing, file sharing, or grassroots distribution circuits—reveal erratic and coincidental links between producers everywhere, which simultaneously constitute dispersed audiences.

但与此同时，也存在依靠手机摄影机、家用电脑和非常规传播形式进行的贫穷影像生产与流通。它的视觉连接——集体剪辑、文件共享或草根传播回路——揭示出各地生产者之间游移而偶然的联系；这些生产者同时也构成了分散的观众。

The circulation of poor images feeds into both capitalist media assembly lines and alternative audiovisual economies. In addition to a lot of confusion and stupefaction, it also possibly creates disruptive movements of thought and affect. The circulation of poor images thus initiates another chapter in the historical genealogy of nonconformist information circuits: Vertov's "visual bonds," the internationalist workers pedagogies that Peter Weiss described in The Aesthetics of Resistance, the circuits of Third Cinema and Tricontinentalism, of non-aligned filmmaking and thinking. The poor image—ambivalent as its status may be—thus takes its place in the genealogy of carbon-copied pamphlets, cine-train agit-prop films, underground video magazines and other nonconformist materials, which aesthetically often used poor materials. Moreover, it reactualizes many of the historical ideas associated with these circuits, among others Vertov's idea of the visual bond.

贫穷影像的流通，既流入资本主义媒介流水线，也流入另类视听经济。除制造大量混乱与愚昧之外，它也可能带来扰动思想和情动的运动。由此，贫穷影像的流通在不从众信息回路的历史谱系中开启了新的一章：维尔托夫的"视觉纽带"、彼得·魏斯在《反抗的美学》中描述的国际主义工人教育，以及第三电影和三洲主义、不结盟电影创作与思想的回路。因此，贫穷影像——无论其地位多么暧昧——在复写传单、电影列车的鼓动宣传片、地下录像杂志及其他不从众材料的谱系中，占据了自己的位置；这些材料在美学上也经常使用贫乏的资源。此外，它还重新激活了与这些回路有关的许多历史观念，其中包括维尔托夫的视觉纽带观念。

Imagine somebody from the past with a beret asking you, "Comrade, what is your visual bond today?"

想象一位戴着贝雷帽、从过去走来的人问你："同志，今天你的视觉纽带是什么？"

You might answer: it is this link to the present.

你可以回答：就是这条通往当下的链接。

6. Now!

6. 当下！

The poor image embodies the afterlife of many former masterpieces of cinema and video art. It has been expelled from the sheltered paradise that cinema seems to have once been.[17] After being kicked out of the protected and often protectionist arena of national culture, discarded from commercial circulation, these works have become travelers in a digital no-man's land, constantly shifting their resolution and format, speed and media, sometimes even losing names and credits along the way.

贫穷影像承载着许多昔日电影与录像艺术杰作的后世生命。它已被逐出电影似乎曾经提供的、受到庇护的天堂。[17] 这些作品被踢出民族文化那片受到保护、且往往带有保护主义色彩的领域，又被商业流通抛弃，因而成为数字无人地带的旅人，不断改变分辨率与格式、速度与媒介，有时甚至在途中失去片名与演职员署名。

Now many of these works are back—as poor images, I admit. One could of course argue that this is not the real thing, but then—please, anybody—show me this real thing.

如今，这些作品中的许多又回来了——我承认，是以贫穷影像的形式。人们当然可以争辩，说这不是真正的东西；那么，拜托，无论谁都好——请把这个真正的东西拿给我看。

The poor image is no longer about the real thing—the originary original. Instead, it is about its own real conditions of existence: about swarm circulation, digital dispersion, fractured and flexible temporalities. It is about defiance and appropriation just as it is about conformism and exploitation.

贫穷影像所关涉的，已不再是真正的东西，即那个作为本源的原作。它关涉的，是自身真实的生存条件：蜂群式流通、数字离散、破碎而灵活的时间性。它既关涉反抗与挪用，也关涉顺从与剥削。

In short: it is about reality.

简言之：它关乎现实。

Notes
注释

原文正式注释共17条，编号依原网页恢复。正文中未形成正式编号的Espinosa引文另记为[A]；该引文署名为Julio，正文署名为Juan，均照录。

[1] Deconstructing Harry, directed by Woody Allen (1997).

［1］《解构哈里》，伍迪・艾伦导演，1997年。

[2] “Wer Gemälde wirklich sehen will, geht ja schließlich auch ins Museum,” Frankfurter Allgemeine Zeitung, June 14, 2007. Conversation between Harun Farocki and Alexander Horwath.

［2］《想真正看绘画的人，终究也会去博物馆》，《法兰克福汇报》，2007年6月14日。哈伦・法罗基与亚历山大・霍瓦特的对谈。

[3] Sven Lütticken’s excellent text “Viewing Copies: On the Mobility of Moving Images,” in e-flux journal, no. 8 (May 2009), drew my attention to this aspect of poor images. See →. [link]

［3］斯文・吕蒂肯的出色文章《观看用拷贝：论活动影像的流动性》，发表于《e-flux journal》第8期，2009年5月，使我注意到贫穷影像的这一面向。参见原文链接。［原文链接］

[4] Thanks to Kodwo Eshun for pointing this out.

［4］感谢科德沃・埃顺指出这一点。

[5] Of course in some cases images with low resolution also appear in mainstream media environments (mainly news), where they are associated with urgency, immediacy, and catastrophe—and are extremely valuable. See Hito Steyerl, “Documentary Uncertainty,” A Prior 15 (2007).

［5］当然，在某些情况下，低分辨率影像也出现在主流媒介环境中，主要是新闻；在其中，它们与紧迫性、即时性及灾难联系在一起，并且极具价值。参见Hito Steyerl，《纪录片的不确定性》，《A Prior》第15期，2007年。

[6] Hito Steyerl, “Politics of the Archive: Translations in Film,” Transversal (March 2008), →. [link]

［6］Hito Steyerl，《档案的政治：电影中的翻译》，《Transversal》，2008年3月。参见原文链接。［原文链接］

[7] From correspondence with the author via e-mail.

［7］来自与本文作者的电子邮件通信。

[8] See Paolo Virno, A Grammar of the Multitude: For an Analysis of Contemporary Forms of Life (Cambridge, MA: MIT Press, 2004).

［8］参见保罗・维尔诺，《诸众的语法：当代生活形式分析》，马萨诸塞州剑桥：麻省理工学院出版社，2004年。

[9] See Alex Alberro, Conceptual Art and the Politics of Publicity (Cambridge, MA: MIT Press, 2003).

［9］参见亚历克斯・阿尔贝罗，《观念艺术与宣传的政治》，马萨诸塞州剑桥：麻省理工学院出版社，2003年。

[10] See Félix Guattari, “Capital as the Integral of Power Formations,” in Soft Subversions (New York: Semiotext(e), 1996), 202.
［10］参见费利克斯・瓜塔里，《作为权力构成之积分的资本》，收入《柔性颠覆》，纽约：Semiotext(e)，1996年，第202页。

[11] All these developments are discussed in detail in an excellent text by Simon Sheikh, “Objects of Study or Commodification of Knowledge? Remarks on Artistic Research,” Art & Research 2, no. 2 (Spring 2009), →.
［11］西蒙・谢赫的出色文章《研究对象，还是知识的商品化？关于艺术研究的若干意见》，对这些发展作了详尽讨论。文章发表于《Art & Research》第2卷第2期，2009年春。参见原文链接。

[12] See also Alan Sekula, “Reading an Archive: Photography between Labour and Capital,” in Visual Culture: The Reader, ed. Stuart Hall and Jessica Evans (London/New York: Routledge 1999), 181–192.
［12］另见艾伦・塞库拉，《阅读档案：劳动与资本之间的摄影》，收入斯图亚特・霍尔、杰西卡・埃文斯编《视觉文化读本》，伦敦 / 纽约：Routledge，1999年，第181至192页。

[13] See Alberro, Conceptual Art and the Politics of Publicity.
［13］参见阿尔贝罗，《观念艺术与宣传的政治》。

[14] The Pirate Bay even seems to have tried acquiring the extraterritorial oil platform of Sealand in order to install its servers there. See Jan Libbenga, "The Pirate Bay plans to buy Sealand," The Register, January 12, 2007, →. [link]
［14］海盗湾似乎甚至曾试图购入位于领海外的西兰海上平台，以便在那里安置服务器。参见Jan Libbenga，《海盗湾计划购买西兰》，《The Register》，2007年1月12日。参见原文链接。［原文链接］

[15] Dziga Vertov, “Kinopravda and Radiopravda,” in Kino-Eye: The Writings of Dziga Vertov, ed. Annette Michelson (Berkeley: University of California Press, 1995), 52.
［15］吉加・维尔托夫，《电影真理报与无线电真理报》，收入安妮特・米歇尔森编《电影眼：吉加・维尔托夫文集》，伯克利：加利福尼亚大学出版社，1995年，第52页。

[16] Vertov, “Kinopravda and Radiopravda,” 52.
［16］维尔托夫，《电影真理报与无线电真理报》，第52页。

[17] At least from the perspective of nostalgic delusion.
［17］至少从怀旧幻觉的角度看来是如此。

[A] Julio García Espinosa, “For an Imperfect Cinema,” trans. Julianne Burton, Jump Cut, no. 20 (1979): 24–26.
［A］Julio García Espinosa，《为一种不完美的电影》，Julianne Burton译，《Jump Cut》第20期，1979年，第24至26页。

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本文的一个早期版本，是我在2007年德国吕讷堡“散文电影——美学与当下性”会议上的即兴回应；会议由托马斯·托德和斯文·克拉默组织。本文极大地受益于《Third Text》客座编辑科德沃·埃顺的意见与评论。他约请我撰写一个更长的版本，用于《Third Text》将于2010年推出的克里斯·马克与第三电影专号，该期由罗斯·格雷共同编辑。本文另一重要灵感来源，是2008年由波莉·斯特普尔在伦敦当代艺术学院策划的“弥散”展览，其中包括一本由斯特普尔和理查德·伯基特编辑的精彩读本。本文也极大地受益于布赖恩·宽·伍德的编辑工作。

About the author (2009)
作者简介（2009年原文）

Hito Steyerl is a filmmaker and writer. She teaches New Media Art at University of Arts Berlin and has recently participated in Documenta 12, Shanghai Biennial, and Rotterdam Film Festival.

Hito Steyerl是一位电影制作者和作家。她在柏林艺术大学教授新媒体艺术，近期曾参与第12届文献展、上海双年展及鹿特丹电影节。

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